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Course: 21LEM202T - Universal Human Values - II

Unit – 2 : Session – 7 | Response vs Reaction

Part C — Long-Answer Questions (Solutions)

1. Q1. RESPONSE = acting after SEEING the situation with understanding — the Self evaluates and then chooses the conduct; REACTION = an automatic conduct triggered by the sensation/assumption without seeing. In response, the decision comes from within (natural acceptance + knowledge) — 'you are self-organised'; in reaction, the trigger comes from outside — other people's words, events, provocations decide your behaviour, as if 'your remote control is with others'. Response is definite and harmonious; reaction is indefinite and often regretted.
2. Q2. LACK OF INTENTION vs LACK OF COMPETENCE (from the film's events): intention is the inner want — 'I WANT the other's good'; competence is the outer ability — 'I AM ABLE to do good'. The film shows characters who genuinely wished well (intention present) but hurt others through clumsy behaviour (competence lacking) — e.g., a parent scolding a child out of care. When we evaluate ourselves we cite intention; when we judge others we cite competence (behaviour). Right evaluation: trust the other's intention while helping build competence.
3. Q3. People decide on three bases: (1) PRECONDITIONING — 'this is how it is done / what people say'; (2) SENSATION — 'what feels good right now'; (3) NATURAL ACCEPTANCE — 'what is truly right, verified within'. Only the THIRD leads to definite, self-organised conduct, because natural acceptance is constant, universal and unconditional — decisions taken on it do not swing with crowd opinion or mood.
4. Q4. SELF-ESTIMATE: on honest review I respond about 40% of the time and react about 60% — reacting most in traffic, in arguments, and to criticism. EFFORT required to move from reaction to response: (a) PAUSE before acting — create a gap between sensation and conduct; (b) practice observing imagination daily; (c) verify assumptions against natural acceptance; (d) assume the other's right intention; (e) review the day's reactions each night. With this practice the share of response steadily rises.